

JIA, Mengzhao (she/her)

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Education

Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering

08/2023 – 07/2027 (expected)

University of Notre Dame, USA. Advisor: Prof. Meng Jiang

M. S. in Computer Science and Engineering

09/2020 – 06/2023

Shandong University, China. Advisor: Prof. Liqiang Nie

B. Eng in Electronic Science and Technology

09/2016 – 06/2020

Shandong University, China.

Work Experience

Research Intern at Orby AI, Mountain View, US. *Worked on Pub.[2]*

03/2025 – 09/2025

Research Intern at Tencent AI Lab, Seattle, US. *Worked on Pub.[4]*

05/2024 – 09/2024

Research Interest: Multimodal Reasoning. Multimodal Large Language Models.

Google Scholar: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=E332upAAAAAJ>

Citations: 578; h-index: 12; i10-index: 14

(09/2026)

Recent Work

1. **Mengzhao Jia**, Yang Lin, Xixin Zhang, Zhihan Zhang, Xiaobai Liu, Meng Jiang. *Agent as Policy for Robotic Manipulation*. arXiv 2026. [[Arxiv](#)] *TL;DR*: AGP uses a general purpose agent as a robot policy, combining visual reasoning, programming, and physical feedback to perform zero-shot manipulation tasks.
2. **Mengzhao Jia**, Zhihan Zhang, Ignacio Cases, Zheyuan Liu, Meng Jiang, Peng Qi. *AutoRubric: Rubric-Based Generative Rewards for Faithful Multimodal Reasoning*. Findings of ACL 2026 [[ACL](#)] [[GitHub](#)] *TL;DR*: AutoRubric uses automatically generated rubrics in multimodal reinforcement learning to improve both accuracy and reasoning faithfulness.
3. **Mengzhao Jia**, Zhihan Zhang, Meng Jiang. *Prioritizing the Best: Incentivizing Reliable Multimodal Reasoning by Rewarding Beyond Answer Correctness*. Findings of EMNLP 2026 (accepted). [[Arxiv](#)] [[Google Scholar](#)] *TL;DR*: Groupwise Ranking Reward ranks verifier-passed trajectories to improve the reliability of multimodal reasoning beyond final-answer correctness.
4. **Mengzhao Jia**, Wenhao Yu, Kaixin Ma, Tianqing Fang, Zhihan Zhang, Siru Ouyang, Hongming Zhang, Dong Yu, Meng Jiang. *Leopard: A Vision Language Model for Text-Rich Multi-Image Tasks*. TMLR 2025. [[Arxiv](#)] [[GitHub](#)] [[HuggingFace](#)] *TL;DR*: Leopard outperforms the best multimodal large language models by an average of +9.61 points on 5 text-rich, multi-image benchmarks. The constructed multi-image reasoning dataset got 200k+ downloads.
5. Zifeng Zhu*, **Mengzhao Jia***, Zhihan Zhang, Lang Li, Meng Jiang. *MultiChartQA: Benchmarking Vision-Language Models on Multi-Chart Problems*. NAACL 2025. [[ACL Anthology](#)] [[HuggingFace](#)] *TL;DR*: MultiChartQA evaluates how MLLMs perform multi-hop, comparative, and sequential reasoning across multiple charts.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

6. **Jia**, Wei, Song, Sun, Zhang, Nie. *Query-Oriented Micro-Video Summarization*. IEEE **TPAMI**, 46 (6), 4174–4187, 2024.
7. **Jia**, Xie, Jing. *Debiasing Multimodal Sarcasm Detection with Contrastive Learning*. **AAAI** 2024.
8. **Jia**, Chen, Jing, Fu, Li. *Knowledge-Enhanced Memory Model for Emotional Support Conversation*. Machine Learning for Cognitive and Mental Health Workshop, **AAAI** 2024.
9. Yang, Guo, **Jia**, Su, Liu, Zhang, Jiang. *MMTutorBench: The First Multimodal Benchmark for AI Math Tutoring*. **ACL** 2026.
10. Liu, Dou, **Jia**, Tan, Zeng, Yuan, Jiang. *Protecting Privacy in Multimodal Large Language Models with MLLMU-Bench*. **NAACL** 2025.
11. Ouyang, Yu, Ma, Xiao, Zhang, **Jia**, et al. *RepoGraph: Enhancing AI Software Engineering with Repository-Level Code Graph*. **ICLR** 2025.
12. Zhang, Ge, Liang, Yu, Yu, **Jia**, Yu, Jiang. *Learn Beyond The Answer: Training Language Models with Reflection for Mathematical Reasoning*. **EMNLP** 2024.
13. Zhang, Lee, Fang, Yu, **Jia**, Jiang, Barbieri. *PLUG: Leveraging Pivot Language in Cross-Lingual Instruction Tuning*. **ACL** 2024.
14. Jing, Song, Ouyang, **Jia**, Nie. *Multi-source Semantic Graph-based Multimodal Sarcasm Explanation Generation*. **ACL** 2023.
15. Nie, **Jia**, Song, Wu, Cheng, Gu. *Multimodal Activation: Awakening Dialog Robots without Wake Words*. **SIGIR** 2021.

Service

Reviewer for ACL, ICLR, CVPR, AAAI